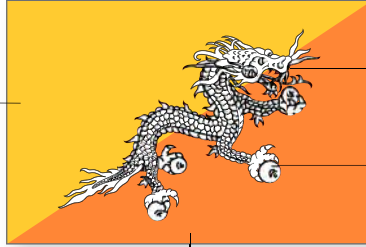


Bhutan

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** c. 1965 **Usage:** National and Civil

*Saffron yellow
denotes the
authority of
the King*



*The “Thunder
Dragon”*

*White represents
purity and loyalty*

*Orange represents the Drukpa
monasteries and religious practices*

Asia



Bhutan is a Buddhist state where power is shared by the king and government. The country’s name in the local dialect means “Land of the Dragon.”

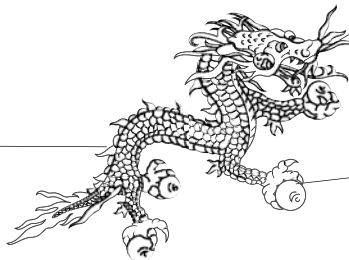
In Bhutan, thunder is believed to be the voices of dragons roaring. In about 1200, a monastery was set up called the *Druk* (the “Thunder Dragon”), with a sect called the Drukpas named after it. The name and the emblem of the dragon have been associated with Bhutan ever since. The dragon on the flag is white to symbolize purity.

TEMPORAL AND SPIRITUAL POWER

The two colors of the flag, divided diagonally, represent spiritual and temporal power within Bhutan. The orange part of the flag represents the Drukpa monasteries and Buddhist religious practice, while the saffron yellow field denotes the secular authority of the royal dynasty of the Wangchuks.

EMBLEM OF BHUTAN

*The dragon symbolizes
Druk, the Tibetan
name for the Kingdom
of Bhutan*



*The snarling mouth
expresses the strength
of the male and female
deities protecting the
country*

*Jewels clasped in
the dragon’s claws
symbolize wealth*